# ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS AND THE SECOND ARC

**TWO COMMISSIONS, TWO QUESTIONS → FIVE-STATUS LADDER → THE LADDER WRITTEN AS → ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS ONE → ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS NINE → NODAL DEPARTMENT CARD**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

## STAGE 00 — TWO COMMISSIONS, TWO QUESTIONS

TWO COMMISSIONS, TWO QUESTIONS · FIRST COMMISSION · 1966 TO 1970: MORARJI DESAI, LATER K. HANUMANTHAIAH · QUESTION ASKED · HOW TO BUILD AN ADMINISTRATIVE STRUCTURE FOR A PLANNING-ERA · SECOND COMMISSION · CONSTITUTED 2005; M. VEERAPPA MOILY; FIFTEEN REPORTS, 2006 TO · HOW TO MAKE AN EXISTING STRUCTURE ACCOUNTABLE AND TECHNOLOGY-ENABLED

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| FIRST COMMISSION → 1966 to 1970; Morarji Desai, later K. Hanumanthaiah | SECOND COMMISSION → constituted 2005; M. Veerappa Moily; fifteen reports, 2006 to 2009 | MUST REMEMBER: Administrative reform changes structures, processes, personnel, ethics,... |
| QUESTION ASKED → how to build an administrative structure for a planning-era state | QUESTION ASKED → how to make an existing structure accountable and technology-enabled | FIRST COMMISSION → 1966 to 1970; Morarji Desai, later K. Hanumanthaiah |

**CORE CLAIM**
- FIRST COMMISSION → 1966 to 1970; Morarji Desai, later K. Hanumanthaiah
- QUESTION ASKED → how to build an administrative structure for a planning-era state

**MECHANISM**
- SECOND COMMISSION → constituted 2005; M. Veerappa Moily; fifteen reports, 2006 to 2009
- QUESTION ASKED → how to make an existing structure accountable and technology-enabled

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- MUST REMEMBER: Administrative reform changes structures, processes, personnel, ethics,...
- FIRST COMMISSION → 1966 to 1970; Morarji Desai, later K. Hanumanthaiah

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Administrative reform changes structures, processes, personnel, ethics,.**

01

## STAGE 01 — FIVE-STATUS LADDER

FIVE-STATUS LADDER · THE REPORT TEXT ALONE; THE COMMONEST ERROR IS PRESENTING · ACCEPTED IN PRINCIPLE · A RECORDED DECISION WITH NO OPERATIVE INSTRUMENT · NOTIFIED OR ENACTED · AN ACT, RULE, ORDER OR SCHEME INSTRUMENT EXISTS · INSTITUTIONS, STAFF, BUDGET AND PROCEDURE ARE ACTUALLY FUNCTIONING · INDEPENDENT EVIDENCE EXISTS ON IMPLEMENTATION QUALITY AND OUTCOME

PROPOSED → the report text alone; the commonest error is presenting this as practice

ACCEPTED IN PRINCIPLE → a recorded decision with no operative instrument → NOTIFIED OR ENACTED → an Act, rule, order or scheme instrument exists → OPERATIONAL → institutions, staff, budget and procedure are actually functioning

**CORE CLAIM**
- PROPOSED → the report text alone; the commonest error is presenting this as practice
- ACCEPTED IN PRINCIPLE → a recorded decision with no operative instrument

**MECHANISM**
- NOTIFIED OR ENACTED → an Act, rule, order or scheme instrument exists
- OPERATIONAL → institutions, staff, budget and procedure are actually functioning

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- EVALUATED → independent evidence exists on implementation quality and outcome
- PROPOSED → the report text alone; the commonest error is presenting this as practice

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOTIFIED OR ENACTED → an Act, rule, order or scheme instrument exists.**

02

## STAGE 02 — THE LADDER WRITTEN AS ONE SENTENCE

THE LADDER WRITTEN AS ONE SENTENCE · STEP 1 · THE COMMISSION RECOMMENDED THE MEASURE · STEP 2 · THE GOVERNMENT ACCEPTED IT IN PRINCIPLE · STEP 3 · THE OPERATIVE INSTRUMENT IS THE NAMED LATER ACT, RULE · STEP 4

STEP 1 → the commission recommended the measure

STEP 2 → the government accepted it in principle → STEP 3 → the operative instrument is the named later Act, rule or scheme → STEP 4 → whether it functions as intended has not been independently evaluated

**CORE CLAIM**
- STEP 1 → the commission recommended the measure
- STEP 2 → the government accepted it in principle

**MECHANISM**
- STEP 3 → the operative instrument is the named later Act, rule or scheme
- STEP 4 → whether it functions as intended has not been independently evaluated

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- STEP 1 → the commission recommended the measure
- STEP 2 → the government accepted it in principle

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STEP 3 → the operative instrument is the named later Act, rule or scheme.**

03

## STAGE 03 — ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS ONE TO EIGHT

ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS ONE TO EIGHT · 1 RIGHT TO INFORMATION · TRANSPARENCY AND ACCOUNTABILITY OWNER · 2 UNLOCKING HUMAN CAPITAL · POLICY DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION OWNER · 3 CRISIS MANAGEMENT · PAPER-III DISASTER-MANAGEMENT SPACE; CROSS-REFERENCE ONLY · 4 ETHICS IN GOVERNANCE

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| 1 RIGHT TO INFORMATION → transparency and accountability owner | 4 ETHICS IN GOVERNANCE → institutional accountability owners; personal probity is Ethics | 7 CAPACITY BUILDING FOR CONFLICT RESOLUTION → cross-reference only |
| 2 UNLOCKING HUMAN CAPITAL → policy design and implementation owner | 5 PUBLIC ORDER → Paper-III internal-security space; cross-reference only | 8 COMBATING TERRORISM → Paper-III internal-security space; cross-reference only |
| 3 CRISIS MANAGEMENT → Paper-III disaster-management space; cross-reference only | 6 LOCAL GOVERNANCE → local governance and service delivery owner | |

**CORE CLAIM**
- 1 RIGHT TO INFORMATION → transparency and accountability owner
- 2 UNLOCKING HUMAN CAPITAL → policy design and implementation owner
- 3 CRISIS MANAGEMENT → Paper-III disaster-management space; cross-reference only

**MECHANISM**
- 4 ETHICS IN GOVERNANCE → institutional accountability owners; personal probity is Ethics
- 5 PUBLIC ORDER → Paper-III internal-security space; cross-reference only
- 6 LOCAL GOVERNANCE → local governance and service delivery owner

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- 7 CAPACITY BUILDING FOR CONFLICT RESOLUTION → cross-reference only
- 8 COMBATING TERRORISM → Paper-III internal-security space; cross-reference only

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 8 COMBATING TERRORISM → Paper-III internal-security space; cross-reference only.**

04

## STAGE 04 — ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS NINE TO FIFTEEN

ROUTING TABLE, REPORTS NINE TO FIFTEEN · 9 SOCIAL CAPITAL · CIVIL-SOCIETY, SELF-HELP-GROUP AND NON-GOVERNMENTAL-ORGANISATION OWNER · 10 REFURBISHING OF PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION · CIVIL SERVICES AND CAPACITY OWNER · 11 PROMOTING E-GOVERNANCE · E-GOVERNANCE MODELS AND USER-CENTRICITY OWNER · 12 CITIZEN-CENTRIC ADMINISTRATION

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| 9 SOCIAL CAPITAL → civil-society, self-help-group and non-governmental-organisation owner | 12 CITIZEN-CENTRIC ADMINISTRATION → citizen-centric administration owner | 15 STATE AND DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION → local governance and district delivery owner |
| 10 REFURBISHING OF PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION → civil services and capacity owner | 13 ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE OF GOVERNMENT → machinery and coordination; Polity cross-link | |
| 11 PROMOTING E-GOVERNANCE → e-governance models and user-centricity owner | 14 STRENGTHENING FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT → public finance and service-delivery tools owner | |

**CORE CLAIM**
- 9 SOCIAL CAPITAL → civil-society, self-help-group and non-governmental-organisation owner
- 10 REFURBISHING OF PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION → civil services and capacity owner
- 11 PROMOTING E-GOVERNANCE → e-governance models and user-centricity owner

**MECHANISM**
- 12 CITIZEN-CENTRIC ADMINISTRATION → citizen-centric administration owner
- 13 ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE OF GOVERNMENT → machinery and coordination; Polity cross-link
- 14 STRENGTHENING FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT → public finance and service-delivery tools owner

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- 15 STATE AND DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION → local governance and district delivery owner

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 15 STATE AND DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION → local governance and district delivery owner.**

05

## STAGE 05 — NODAL DEPARTMENT CARD

NODAL DEPARTMENT CARD · WHAT IT IS · THE NODAL UNION DEPARTMENT FOR TRACKING AND COORDINATING FOLLOW-UP · WHAT IT DOES · CIRCULATES RECOMMENDATIONS, HOLDS INSTITUTIONAL MEMORY, COORDINATES MINISTRIES · WHAT IT CANNOT DO · COMPEL A LINE MINISTRY OR A STATE GOVERNMENT TO · NON-IMPLEMENTATION IS OFTEN AN INSTITUTIONAL FACT, NOT AN ATTITUDE

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| WHAT IT IS → the nodal Union department for tracking and coordinating follow-up | WHAT IT CANNOT DO → compel a line ministry or a State government to implement anything | CLOSE DISTINCTION: Commission recommendation is not law, acceptance in principle is not... |
| WHAT IT DOES → circulates recommendations, holds institutional memory, coordinates ministries | CONSEQUENCE → non-implementation is often an institutional fact, not an attitude | WHAT IT IS → the nodal Union department for tracking and coordinating follow-up |

**CORE CLAIM**
- WHAT IT IS → the nodal Union department for tracking and coordinating follow-up
- WHAT IT DOES → circulates recommendations, holds institutional memory, coordinates ministries

**MECHANISM**
- WHAT IT CANNOT DO → compel a line ministry or a State government to implement anything
- CONSEQUENCE → non-implementation is often an institutional fact, not an attitude

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Commission recommendation is not law, acceptance in principle is not...
- WHAT IT IS → the nodal Union department for tracking and coordinating follow-up

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Commission recommendation is not law, acceptance in principle is not.**

06

## STAGE 06 — DIAGNOSIS TO OUTCOME CHAIN

DIAGNOSIS TO OUTCOME CHAIN · THE COMMISSION IDENTIFIES A STRUCTURAL PROBLEM · ACCEPTANCE, REPORT BY REPORT; FAILURE MODE IS ACCEPTANCE IN · AN ACT, RULE, ORDER OR SCHEME MUST BE SEPARATELY · FEDERAL STEP · STATE SUBJECTS NEED STATE ACTION; A UNION ACCEPTANCE CANNOT · CAPACITY, THEN INCENTIVE · WHO LOSES DISCRETION, AUTHORITY OR RENT?

DIAGNOSIS → the commission identifies a structural problem → ACCEPTANCE, report by report; failure mode is acceptance in principle with no instrument → INSTRUMENT: an Act, rule, order or scheme must be separately created → FEDERAL STEP: State subjects need State action; a Union acceptance cannot deliver them → CAPACITY, then INCENTIVE: who loses discretion, authority or rent?

**CORE CLAIM**
- DIAGNOSIS → the commission identifies a structural problem
- ACCEPTANCE, report by report; failure mode is acceptance in principle with no instrument

**MECHANISM**
- INSTRUMENT: an Act, rule, order or scheme must be separately created
- FEDERAL STEP: State subjects need State action; a Union acceptance cannot deliver them

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- CAPACITY, then INCENTIVE: who loses discretion, authority or rent?
- OUTCOME: partial adoption, often unattributed and frequently unevaluated

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: an Act, rule, order or scheme must be separately created.**

07

## STAGE 07 — THE FEDERAL EXPLANATION

THE FEDERAL EXPLANATION · STATE-ACTION REPORTS · LOCAL GOVERNANCE; STATE AND DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION · PARTLY STATE-ACTION · MUCH OF REFURBISHING OF PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION · UNION ACCEPTANCE CANNOT LEGISLATE OR STAFF A STATE SUBJECT · EXPLAINS UNEVEN NATIONAL ADOPTION WITHOUT ASSERTING UNION INDIFFERENCE

STATE-ACTION REPORTS → Local Governance; State and District Administration → PARTLY STATE-ACTION → much of Refurbishing of Personnel Administration → MECHANISM → Union acceptance cannot legislate or staff a State subject → USE → explains uneven national adoption without asserting Union indifference

**CORE CLAIM**
- STATE-ACTION REPORTS → Local Governance; State and District Administration
- PARTLY STATE-ACTION → much of Refurbishing of Personnel Administration

**MECHANISM**
- MECHANISM → Union acceptance cannot legislate or staff a State subject
- USE → explains uneven national adoption without asserting Union indifference

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- STATE-ACTION REPORTS → Local Governance; State and District Administration
- PARTLY STATE-ACTION → much of Refurbishing of Personnel Administration

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: USE → explains uneven national adoption without asserting Union indifference.**

08

## STAGE 08 — THE ATTRIBUTION TRAP

THE ATTRIBUTION TRAP · A LATER REFORM RESEMBLES A REPORT, SO THE ANSWER · CAUSATION IS USUALLY UNPROVABLE WITHOUT A SOURCED ACCEPTANCE OR · NAMED RISK · CAPACITY PROGRAMMES AND STATE SERVICE-GUARANTEE STATUTES ARE THE USUAL · CORRECT MOVE · STATE THEMATIC CONTINUITY, AND SAY THAT THE LINKAGE IS

**CORE CLAIM**
- TEMPTATION → a later reform resembles a report, so the answer claims implementation
- REALITY → causation is usually unprovable without a sourced acceptance or decision trail

**MECHANISM**
- NAMED RISK → capacity programmes and State service-guarantee statutes are the usual claims
- CORRECT MOVE → state thematic continuity, and say that the linkage is not verified

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- TEMPTATION → a later reform resembles a report, so the answer claims implementation
- REALITY → causation is usually unprovable without a sourced acceptance or decision trail

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CORRECT MOVE → state thematic continuity, and say that the linkage is not verified.**

09

## STAGE 09 — DATEDNESS OBJECTION AND REPLY

DATEDNESS OBJECTION AND REPLY · A 2006 TO 2009 DIAGNOSIS PREDATES POPULATION-SCALE DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE · IT ALSO PREDATES THE CURRENT DATA-PROTECTION FRAMEWORK AND LATER · THE ANALYTICAL CATEGORIES HAVE AGED FAR BETTER THAN THE · SAY WHICH OF THE TWO THE ANSWER IS ACTUALLY

**CORE CLAIM**
- OBJECTION → a 2006 to 2009 diagnosis predates population-scale digital infrastructure
- OBJECTION → it also predates the current data-protection framework and later fiscal design

**MECHANISM**
- REPLY → the analytical categories have aged far better than the specific prescriptions
- DISCIPLINE → say which of the two the answer is actually using

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- OBJECTION → a 2006 to 2009 diagnosis predates population-scale digital infrastructure
- OBJECTION → it also predates the current data-protection framework and later fiscal design

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → say which of the two the answer is actually using.**

10

## STAGE 10 — POLITICAL ECONOMY OF ADOPTION

POLITICAL ECONOMY OF ADOPTION · COMPREHENSIVE PROGRAMME · ANALYTICALLY COMPLETE AND POLITICALLY INDIGESTIBLE · INCREMENTAL REFORM · IMPLEMENTABLE AND INCOHERENT ACROSS THE SYSTEM · COMMISSION FATIGUE · REPEATED COMMISSIONS CONVERT REFORM INTO A DOCUMENTED INTENTION · COST DISTRIBUTION

COMPREHENSIVE PROGRAMME → analytically complete and politically indigestible · INCREMENTAL REFORM → implementable and incoherent across the system · COMMISSION FATIGUE → repeated commissions convert reform into a documented intention · COST DISTRIBUTION → concentrated resistance against diffuse benefit decides adoption

**CORE CLAIM**
- COMPREHENSIVE PROGRAMME → analytically complete and politically indigestible
- INCREMENTAL REFORM → implementable and incoherent across the system

**MECHANISM**
- COMMISSION FATIGUE → repeated commissions convert reform into a documented intention
- COST DISTRIBUTION → concentrated resistance against diffuse benefit decides adoption

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- COMPREHENSIVE PROGRAMME → analytically complete and politically indigestible
- INCREMENTAL REFORM → implementable and incoherent across the system

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST DISTRIBUTION → concentrated resistance against diffuse benefit decides adoption.**

11

## STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE FOR A REFORM DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A REFORM DEMAND · NAME THE REPORT BY TITLE AND THE GOVERNANCE PROBLEM · ROUTE THE THEME TO ITS DESTINATION OWNER AND TAKE · ATTACH A STATUS LABEL, THEN GIVE THE FEDERAL OR · GRADED VERDICT ON CONTINUING RELEVANCE WITH THE DATEDNESS REPLY · EVIDENCE LIMIT · CITE THE RELEVANT SECOND ARC REPORT AND

OPEN → name the report by title and the governance problem it diagnoses → BUILD → route the theme to its destination owner and take the evidence from there → CORRECT → attach a status label, then give the federal or incentive reason for the → CLOSE → graded verdict on continuing relevance with the datedness reply stated → EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Cite the relevant Second ARC report and

**CORE CLAIM**
- OPEN → name the report by title and the governance problem it diagnoses
- BUILD → route the theme to its destination owner and take the evidence from there

**MECHANISM**
- CORRECT → attach a status label, then give the federal or incentive reason for the gap
- CLOSE → graded verdict on continuing relevance with the datedness reply stated

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Cite the relevant Second ARC report and...
- OPEN → name the report by title and the governance problem it diagnoses

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict on continuing relevance with the datedness reply stated.**

E

## EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE SECOND ARC'S OWN INSTITUTIONAL DESIGN (A TIME-BOUND COMMISSION) · THE REPORT-ROUTING TABLE ITSELF ILLUSTRATES A BROADER POINT ABOUT · DARPG FUNCTIONS AS THE CONTINUING INSTITUTIONAL MEMORY AND ROUTING · ADMINISTRATIVE REFORM SHOULD BE EVALUATED AT FOUR LEVELS · LEGAL ADOPTION, ORGANISATIONAL · BECAUSE SEVERAL SECOND ARC RECOMMENDATIONS TOUCH SUBJECTS IN THE · THE 11TH REPORT'S ( PROMOTING E-GOVERNANCE ) RECOMMENDATIONS ALIGNED

**OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH**
- CAUTION: The Second ARC's own institutional design (a time-bound commission producing analytical
- CAUTION: The report-routing table itself illustrates a broader point about GS-II's syllabus
- DARPG functions as the continuing institutional memory and routing mechanism for ARC
- CAUTION: Administrative reform should be evaluated at four levels: legal adoption, organisational

**ADVANCED DEBATE**
- CAUTION: Because several Second ARC recommendations touch subjects in the State List or
- CAUTION: The 11th Report's ( Promoting e-Governance ) recommendations aligned closely with the
- CAUTION: Boundary case: recommendations in the 10th Report ( Refurbishing of Personnel
- CAUTION: Citing the 4th Report ( Ethics in Governance ) analytically in a Governance answer

**LEGACY / NUANCE**
- CAUTION: Expert-commission-driven reform (ARC model) provides rigorous, evidence-based diagnosis
- CAUTION: Treating every ARC recommendation as equally "live" risks anachronism; a rigorous
- CAUTION: Federal subject-matter division means Union-level ARC recommendations on state/
- The Second ARC was constituted in 2005 and its 15 reports were released between 2006

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels